

Claudia Marangon

Email: cmarangon@fas.harvard.edu

Website: <https://claudiamarangon.github.io/>

Mobile: +393401551294

Address: 1727 Cambridge Street (office E304), Cambridge (MA), 02138

Academic Positions	Harvard University Postdoctoral Researcher	2025-
Affiliation	<i>ETH Zurich</i> Center for Law and Economics, Research Affiliate <i>ETH Zurich</i> Public Policy Group, Research Affiliate	2025- 2025-
Education	ETH Zurich Ph.D. in Economics <i>Thesis Title:</i> “Identity and Narratives: Three Essays in Political Economy” <i>Committee:</i> Elliott Ash, Dominik Hangartner, Marco Tabellini	2019-2025
	Bocconi University <i>M. Sc., Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 Cum Laude</i> <i>B. Sc., Economic and Social Sciences, 110/110 Cum Laude</i>	2016-2019 2013-2016
	Harvard Kennedy School Visiting Fellow	Spring 2023
Job Market Paper	Identity in Journalism: Evidence from News Reporting of Violence Against Women <i>Abstract:</i> Does the identity of journalists shape the news, and through it, readers’ behavior? I study this question in the context of reporting on violence against women in Italy. Using the universe of murders with female victims from 2006 to 2022 matched to newspaper articles, I construct validated indexes of two reporting styles: victim-centered narratives, which contextualize the crime and point to support resources, and perpetrator-centered narratives, which focus on motives such as jealousy or a fit of rage. I show that female journalists use more victim-centered and fewer perpetrator-centered narratives, exploiting the conditionally random assignment of reporters to crimes within newsrooms to adjust for selection in the stories and topics covered. Combining reporter assignment with provincial readership in a staggered difference-in-differences design, I show that greater exposure to female reporters after a murder raises calls to the national helpline for violence against women. An online experiment identifies the mechanism: victim-centered narratives shift norms around help-seeking, while perpetrator-centered narratives raise engagement among men but alienate female readers. Reporter identity is thus a consequential supply-side determinant of both news content and reader behavior.	
Publications	WCLD: Curated Large Dataset of Criminal Cases from Wisconsin Circuit Courts with E. Ash, N. Goel, N. Li, and P. Sun Proceedings of the 37th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (2023)	
Working Papers	Judging Disparities: Recidivism Risk, Image Motives, and In-Group Bias on Wisconsin Criminal Courts with E. Ash <i>Abstract:</i> This paper studies racial in-group disparities in Wisconsin, which has one of the highest Black-to-White incarceration rates among all U.S. states. The analysis is motivated by a model in which a judge may want to incarcerate more due to three factors: (1) taste-based preferences about the defendant’s group identity; (2) higher	

recidivism risk where the defendant is more likely to commit future crimes; and (3) image motives stemming from the defendant being in the same group as the judge. Further, a judge may have better information on recidivism risk due to two factors: (4) becoming more experienced, and (5) sharing the same group as the defendant. We take these ideas to new data on 1 million cases from Wisconsin criminal courts, 2005-2017. Looking at racial disparities between majority (White) and minority (Black) judges and defendants, we find no evidence for anti-out-group bias (1). Using a recidivism risk score that we construct using machine learning tools to predict reoffense, we find evidence that judges do tend to incarcerate defendants with a higher recidivism risk (2). Consistent with judge experience leading to better information on defendant recidivism risk (4), we find that more experienced judges are more responsive in jailing defendants with a high recidivism risk score. Consistent with image motives (3), we find that when the minority group is responsible for most crimes, minority-group judges are harsher on their in-group. Finally, consistent with judges having better information on recidivism risk for same-group defendants (5), we find that judges are more responsive to the recidivism risk score for defendants from the same group when that group makes up a relatively small share of defendants.

Ongoing Research *Visual Justice: The Effect of Media Mugshots on Sentencing and Racial Bias*
with E. Ash, S. Galletta, and B. Kohler

What's in a Name? The Effect of Judge-Defendant Name Similarity in Sentencing
with E. Ash

The Persuasive Power of Policy Narratives

Teaching **Lecturer**

Data Science for Public Policy: From Econometrics to AI, ETH Zurich Spring 2025
Text Data in Economics, University of Basel Fall 2023, 2024

Teaching Assistant

Data Science for Decision Making, ETH Zurich Fall 2020-2023
NLP for Law and Political Economy ETH Zurich Spring 2020-2022
Experimental Economics and Psychology, Bocconi University Fall 2018

Grants and Awards

Unicredit Foundation Award for Best Paper in Gender Economics 2026
SNSF Postdoc.Mobility Grant (CHF 136000) 2025-2027
ETH CIS Research Grant (CHF 7680) 2024
ETH Zurich Doc.Mobility Fellowship (CHF 7500) 2023

Professional Activities

Conferences and Seminars

(including scheduled) Workshop on Gender Stereotypes in the Media 2026
and Women in Leadership Positions; Harvard Political Economy Workshop;
CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society; SIOE
Annual Meeting; EEA Annual Meeting; Stanford Institute for Theoretical
Economics Conference, Gender; APSA Annual Meeting

Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series; 1st Workshop IdEP in 2025
Sustainable Economics; 2025 Petralia Workshop; Zurich Workshop in AI &
Economics *(Poster)*; EuroWEPS; Milano Rookie Conference

NBER Summer Institute, Economics of Crime; NICEP Conference; 15th 2024
Transatlantic Workshop in Economics of Crime;
Conference for Empirical Legal Studies; II Political Economy Winter
Workshop *(Poster)*; Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series

ALEA Annual Meeting; Harvard Graduate Student Workshop in Political Economy and Culture; 6th Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop; Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science (*Poster*); WEC.Jr; Narratives, Memory, and Beliefs Summer School and Workshop (*Poster*); Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series; Zurich Workshop in Narratives in Economics 2023

Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series 2022

Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series; Summer Institute in Machine Learning in Economics, University of Chicago Booth School of Business (*summer school*) 2021

Academic Service

Co-Organizer: Online Seminar in Economics + Data Science 2023-

Refereeing: The Economic Journal, Journal of Law and Economics

Other Skills

Languages Italian: Native Speaker; English: Proficient; French: High Intermediate; German: Beginner

Programming Languages and Softwares: Python (Excellent), HTML/CSS (Good), R (Excellent), JavaScript (Good), C++ (Basic), SQL (Basic), STATA (Excellent), Matlab (Good)

References

Elliott Ash

IFW, Haldeneggsteig 4
8092 Zürich, Switzerland
elliott.ash@gess.ethz.ch

Dominik Hangartner

LEH, Leonhardshalde 21
8092 Zürich, Switzerland
dominik.hangartner@gess.ethz.ch

Marco Tabellini

Harvard Business School
02138 Cambridge (MA), U.S.
mtabellini@hbs.edu